Taher Samadi Shal

Senior Game Engineer · Unity (C#) · Unreal Engine 5 (C++) · Multiplayer · Cloud Backends
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SUMMARY

Senior Game Engineer with 13 years shipping Unity and Unreal games on Steam, mobile, and web, including co-founding an award-winning studio. Specialized in multiplayer architecture, serverless game backends, procedural systems, and developer tools. Led engineering on Steam roguelikes, a cross-platform multiplayer TCG, and an unannounced AAA online title.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engines: Unity (C#, editor tooling) · Unreal Engine 5 (C++, Blueprints, replication, seamless travel)
Languages: C#, C++, JavaScript/Node.js, SQL
Multiplayer & Backend: Photon Fusion, PUN 2, Unreal Networking, AWS GameLift, Lambda, API Gateway, Cognito, DynamoDB, S3
Systems: Procedural generation, A* pathfinding & AI, physics/combat, save systems, quests/dialogue, MVVM
Pipelines & Tools: Git, SVN, TeamCity, Unity Cloud Build, GitHub CI, Jira, Visual Studio, Rider, profiling
Platforms: PC/Steam, Mac, iOS, Android, WebGL, PS4

EXPERIENCE

Senior Unity Engineer · DoubleCoconut, San Francisco, CA (Remote) Jan 2026 – Present

- **Architecture Consulting:** Advise client teams on Unity architecture and help maintain mid-core titles in active development.
- **Optimization & Pipelines:** Profile and optimize gameplay code and set up build pipelines for faster client iteration.

Lead Unreal Programmer · Mars Games, Winter Park, FL Dec 2024 – Nov 2025

- **Online Infrastructure:** Architected UE5 C++ networking for an unannounced AAA live-service game on AWS GameLift.
- **Serverless Backend:** Built login and registration on AWS Cognito, API Gateway, and Lambda as scalable serverless services.
- **Cloud Saves:** Engineered a DynamoDB + S3 cloud save system persisting player and world data across servers and sessions.
- **Replication:** Replicated character data via PlayerState, synced procedural world events, and implemented seamless travel.
- **Editor Tools:** Built C++ debugging tools and Unreal editor extensions that shortened the content team's iteration time.

Lead Unity Engineer · LiquidX, Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia (Remote) May 2023 – Sep 2024

- **Technical Lead:** Owned architecture of Warriors of Nova Thera, a Pixelmon roguelike, through its Steam Closed Beta.
- **Multiplayer:** Integrated Photon Fusion to deliver synchronized, responsive multiplayer on top of fast physics-based combat.
- **Procedural World:** Built hex-based procedural maps and a spawn/reward system that scales difficulty and loot to progression.
- **Team Leadership:** Directed enemy AI and UI work, ran code reviews, and automated build pipelines with TeamCity.

Senior Unity Engineer · DoubleCoconut, San Francisco, CA Apr 2021 – Apr 2023

- **Emergents TCG:** Led Unity engineering on a cross-platform multiplayer card game for two years, from concept to Open Beta.
- **Server-Authoritative Rules:** Built a relay-server rules engine with Photon PUN 2 that prevented client-side cheating.
- **Cross-Platform:** Shipped simultaneous Windows, macOS, Android, and WebGL builds tuned for mobile and browser.
- **Delivery:** Coordinated APIs across five teams and shipped stable weekly builds via Unity Cloud Build and GitHub CI.

Senior Unity Engineer · Badbadake Haft Aseman, Tehran, Iran Oct 2018 – Mar 2021

- **Naxia (Steam):** Led technical development of an action-RPG rogue-lite through its Steam release.
- **Procedural Dungeons:** Built dungeon generation with level-scaled enemy spawning and fixed on-the-fly asset loading stalls.
- **RPG Systems:** Engineered branching quests and dialogue, inventory, and saves for complex character and world state.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

Unity Developer · Pardazesh Negar Rashin, Tehran, Iran Sep 2017 – Sep 2018

- Shipped “Saychin,” a multiplayer mobile puzzle game, and several other mobile titles in an Agile/Scrum team (SVN, Jira).

Co-Founder & Unity Developer · Midopia Game Studio, Iran Apr 2013 – Oct 2017

- Led technical development and shipped “Fractality” (Android), winner of the Golden Badge for Best Game of the Year at Iran's 10th Digital Media Festival. Pitched projects and secured external funding.

EDUCATION

M.S., Game Design (STEM) · Full Sail University · Valedictorian
M.S., Business Administration · Azad University
B.S., Industrial Management · University of Guilan

Work Authorization: Authorized to work in the US now (F-1 OPT) and eligible for the 24-month STEM OPT extension. No sponsorship cost to start.